Minutes for the April 8, 2026 Vietnam Veterans of America, Chapter 279 Meeting

The regular meeting of Chapter 279 was called to order by President Hester at 1830 hours on Wednesday, April 8, 2026. After the salute to the American Flag, President Hester led the Chapter in the Pledge of Allegiance. Chaplain Dwain Holmes led the Chapter in prayer. His email is: tukupholmes@gmail.com. His phone number is: 402-999-1108. This is helpful to him—please put it in your contact list.

The Secretary called the roll call of officers: President Terry Hester, Vice President Joe Mangiamelli, Secretary Tom Halbkat, and Treasurer Haase. There are 4 officers present and 36 members present. With that said, we have a quorum.

Election of Officers: After a vote of confidence at last month's meeting, all nominations ceased and Dottie Barickman will swear all present officers in at the May meeting.

Guest Speaker: We had no guest speaker, but next month Laura, David Teer bride is going to talk about Virtual Orchestra, you can sign up for 10 free lessons. That will be fun!

New Members: Ronnie McKay is joining this month. Welcome aboard, Ronnie!

Sick Call: Ron Dupell, Rich Shivley, Tom Brown, Dick Rowe, Larry Mickey. Get well, brothers!

President's Report: President Hester showed the chapter new tee shirts that can be purchased for $10.00 a piece. They will come with the chapter logo, and at that price, it's a steal! He also talked about the 11th annual golf outing. We are going to need volunteers. Elkhorn Days parade will be May 30. Always a good time—let's fill the trailer. Parade starts a 10am. He also informed the chapter about the discount we receive when renewing our license plates. It can be quite large. On May 15, 2026 the American Legion will be closing the purchase of a new club. Looks like we will be moving our meeting place, but more on this down the road.

Secretary Report: Report was emailed to all members. Vice President Mangiamelli moved to accept the report as written and Bill Wagner seconded. Motion carried.

Treasurer Report: Treasurer Haase passed out copies of budget and explained all lines carefully, including a mock budget to 2032. George Abbott moved to accept the budget as presented and Glen Page seconded the motion. Motion carried. There were some bills to be paid; $1,200.00 to the Legion Club for the QOV dinner, and 125.12 to Terry Hester for a QOV cake and a funeral flag. Bill Wagoner made motion to pay the bills and David Teer seconded. Motion carried.

Scholarships: No report

Veterans Home Board: No report

Correspondence Report: Joe Mangiamelli reports that our last National Convention will be held in Washington DC in August of 2027. Everyone needs to read the National President's article in the Veteran Magazine we just received. It should answer a lot of questions we may have. Also, he gave a large thank you to the QOV organization for the fine evening they put on at our dinner. He mentioned that Jim Quick has been named as the new Treasurer of the State Council. Congrates—Jim. We also

need some help presenting JR—ROTC member of the year. Anthony Weathers gave a short talk on being active in the organization.

Veterans Court: Eddie Nelson reports all 27 members are doing what's right. Of the 27 members there are 2 female members.

National VVA Treasurer Report: No report

Nebraska Foundation {NVVMF} Report: No report

Homeless Veterans: No report

Chapter Membership Report: 222 members and 12 associates

POW/MIA: Treasurer Haase reports 1556

Old or New Business: April 25, 1600 monuments {Sec. 8} need to be cleaned. Need volunteers to bring nylon brush. ONC will supply the water. There will be a co-mig burial coming up. Terry will send out info on the later. As a side note, there are 7800 brothers and sisters at home in ONC.

Please check out the chapter's webpage: nebraskavietnamveterans.com

Closing Prayer: Chaplain Holmes

Next Meeting: Wednesday—May, 13, 2026 at 1830 hours. Located at the Millard American Legion Post 374.

Motion to Adjourn: Motion to adjourn made by Mike Steffen, seconded by Andy Doza. Motion carried.

Submitted by: Tom Halbkat--Secretary